

MUHAMMAD JUNAID NAWAZ

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MEAT SCIENTIST · DOCTOR OF VETERINARY MEDICINE

Results-driven Meat Scientist and DVM with 7+ years across academic research, international public health, and industrial R&D. Expertise in developing meat products that incorporate clean-label functional ingredients to mitigate muscle myopathies, alongside postmortem intervention strategies that elevate carcass quality and food safety. Skilled at bridging multi-species fundamental muscle biology with commercial-scale processing systems.

EXPERIENCE

Ph.D. Candidate — Meat Science & Technology JAN 2022 - PRESENT
The University of Georgia · Athens, GA

- Developing chicken products via bench-top & pilot-scale trials incorporating clean-label functional ingredients, such as citrus fiber, to mitigate wooden breast (WB) effects and improve utilization of WB affected breast fillets.
- Designed and supervised trained & consumer sensory panels, actively collaborated in cross-functional research on meat color stability in retail display and beef tenderness across cookery methods.
- JBS Global Ingenuity STEP** — cross-functional meat product development with finance, marketing, R&D, ingredient specialists and culinary teams; formulation judge-selected to advance to scale-up testing.
- International Agribusiness Fellowship, Uruguay** — studied pasture-based beef cattle production, cooperative dairy processing models, and cost optimization strategies across supply chain.

Lecturer — Department of Meat Technology DEC 2018 - JAN 2022
Cholistan University of Veterinary & Animal Sciences · Bahawalpur, PK

- Led curriculum meat science laboratory development; supervised technicians and TAs; provided academic advisement and graduate mentorship.

Veterinary Officer — Livestock Department JUL 2016 - DEC 2018
L&DD, Government of the Punjab · Punjab, PK

- Municipal abattoir inspection and process optimization for public health compliance.
- Disease surveillance for the FAO-led foot-and-mouth disease vaccination program.
- Designed Good Management Practices (GMPs) training modules and upskilled community extension facilitators for outreach activities.

Quality Control Manager JUN 2015 - JUN 2016
Punjab Agriculture & Meat Company / Kold Kraft Tongda · Lahore, PK

- Developed and deployed the plant SOPs, process capable product specifications, and food safety / regulatory architecture.
- R&D product development — developed pressure-packaged frankfurters from concept through commercialization, including formulation, cost analysis, and product specification.
- USAID project trainer — collaborated cross-functionally with operations and regulatory teams for onsite abattoir staff training on Halal standards.

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Candidacy, Animal Science — Meat Science & Technology GPA 3.73
The University of Georgia, Athens, GA · Expected 2026

M.Phil., Meat Science & Technology GPA 3.92
University of Veterinary & Animal Sciences, Lahore, PK · 2018

Advanced Graduate Training — One Health Program GPA 4.00
Global Health Institute, Duke University, NC · 2018 (Supplemental Track)

D.V.M., Doctor of Veterinary Medicine GPA 3.66
University of Veterinary & Animal Sciences, Lahore, PK · 2015

TECHNICAL CAPABILITY

ANALYTICS & INSTRUMENTATION

Texture Profile Analysis, colorimetry, Warner-Bratzler shear force, OCR & MRA, proximate analysis, lipid oxidation (TBARS), water-holding capacity, sensory analysis.

PRODUCT DEVELOPMENT

Manages full product development lifecycle: formulation, regulatory validation, sensory testing, and commercialization.

COMPLIANCE & AUDITING

Deep understanding of USDA-FSIS regulations, CFR criteria, HACCP, Halal Food Management Systems (PS-3733), Good Manufacturing Practices (GMPs).

PROJECT MANAGEMENT & ANALYTICAL PROBLEM-SOLVING

Manages multi-phase R&D projects from concept through commercialization; strong critical thinking and analytical skills applied to data-driven decisions.

AI-AUGMENTED DIGITAL FLUENCY & COMMUNICATION SKILLS

Proficient in MS Office Suite (Word, Excel, PowerPoint) and AI tools; strong verbal, written and presentation skills, conveying technical data to cross-functional partners and lay audiences.

HONORS & AWARDS

2026 PhD Accelerator Award & Global Engagement Travel Abroad Award, UGA

2025 JBS Global Ingenuity STEP — JBS USA, Pilgrim's & AMSA

2023 UGA Graduate School Travel Award — ICoMST, Padova, Italy

2022 C. Boyd Ramsey RMC Scholar Award, American Meat Science Association

2022 Graduate Fellowship / Assistantship, The University of Georgia

2011 Ghulam Hur Gold Medal in Gross Anatomy, UVAS

CERTIFICATIONS

- Food Safety & Science Certification — AMSA via iCEV**
- Carcass Grading & Meat Cuts Standardization — USAID Agribusiness Project**
- Blood Borne Pathogens Training — Duke University OESO**